



Harry Potter

This one is different, here are some hidden clues about Pottermore that you might have missed. <https://digit.in/jul20-41>



Ready Player One

This movie is all about references and denofgeek claims to have listed all of them. <https://digit.in/jul20-42>

which is said by Luke Skywalker just before Ben Solo stabs his space wizard astral projection with a lightsaber.

LOTR

The Lord of the Rings franchise has some unlikely and immersion breaking easter eggs. At Rivendell, when Boromir checks out the shards of Narsil, and comments that they are “still sharp”, it is a reference to the series of British TV movies that Sean Bean starred in, Sharpe. At the bridge of Khazad Dum, Gandalf being grabbed by his legs by the tail of the falling Balrog, is similar to a scene in Aliens where Ripley’s leg is caught in a similar fashion by the Xenomorph queen. Later on, when Gimli, Aragorn and Legolas get captured by the guards of Lothlorien in Fellowship of the Ring, the scene is a homage to a similar scene in The Good, the Bad and the Ugly, where Gimli claims to have superior senses while running straight into an arrow pointed at his face.

In The Two Towers, when the elves begin to make their last journey west, they cross over the bridge in a sequence that is very similar to the Ave Maria sequence from Fantasia. The training formation at the Battle of Helm’s Deep is similar to a scene from Spartacus. When Frodo comes across corpses looking straight up at him in Mordor, that scene is a homage to a nearly identical sequence in Carnival of Souls. Then, the scene where Brego, Aragorn’s horse rescues him after the orc attack, is identical to a scene from Gladiator, right down to the cut on Aragorn’s arm.

In The Return of The King, there are a number of easter eggs to classic old timey movies. The siege of Gondor sequence is very similar to a sequence in Intolerance. Sam’s shadow running up the stairs before him is similar to a scene from The Third Man, a noir thriller from 1949. The prosthetics design of Gothmog, the head orc, is derived from the face of Joseph Merrick, the subject of The Elephant Man film.

Peter Jackson seems to be a big fan of Alfred Hitchcock as there are several camera movements borrowed from Hitchcock movies, including Gandalf sleeping with his eyes open in The Two Towers which is taken from Psycho and the reverse tracking effect from Vertigo in the third movie.

The Return of the King also has a number of homages to science fiction movies. The part where Eowyn promises to save Theoden, and he replies “You already have”, is nearly identical to a scene between Luke Skywalker and Darth Vader in The Return of the Jedi. At the Siege of Gondor, Pippin proclaims that a storm is coming, which is also said

climax set on a crashed Helicarrier in Deadpool, and different versions of Quicksilver existing in both shared universes. The X-Men franchise has a convoluted timeline, which is actually not that surprising considering the source material. The comics are also similarly convoluted. However, an Easter egg from Iron Man shows a really good link between the two franchises, which was much before the link was established. While testing out the MKII suit, Tony Stark competes for speed with the SR-71 Blackbird, which is the aircraft used by the XMen. In Avengers: Endgame, when Scott Lang or the Ant Man is searching the memorial for any



Nick Fury's gravestone

by Sarah Connor in The Terminator. Later on, when Gollum bites off the ring from Frodo’s hand and falls into the lava, the shots are similar to the climax of Terminator 2: Judgement Day, where the Terminator lowers himself into a vat of molten metal. Just before the five endings of the movie, Frodo briefly regains consciousness while being clutched in the talons of eagles while he is being carried away to safety. This is similar to a scene in Mad Max 2 where Max is rescued by the Gyro captain.

MCU

After the Fox acquisition by Disney, fans are eagerly looking forward to seeing how the wide variety of characters from X-Men will integrate into the Marvel Cinematic Universe. There are already some tenuous links between the two, including a

indication of his daughter, one of the names he comes across is Roberto da Costa, which is the name of the mutant called Sunspot from the X-Men.

Some of the connections in MCU movies are to other franchises entirely, based on the actors playing the roles. In Captain America: The First Avenger, while Cap, Colonel Philips and Agent Carter are chasing Valkyrie, the Colonel pushes a red button that has the label “do not push”. The actor who plays Colonel Philips, Tommy Lee Jones also plays Agent K in Men in Black, and has a similar scene in that movie with co-star Will Smith. In the final scene of Avengers: Endgame, the gravestone of Nick Fury quotes Ezekiel 25:17 which says “The path of the righteous man”. The same quote was used by Jules Winnfield, Samuel L Jackson’s character in Pulp Fiction. 